NAZARBAYEV UNIVERSITY

Policy and Procedures on Student Mobility of the autonomous organization of education "Nazarbayev University"

Category: Policy

Approval Date: 07.02.2024

Effective Date: 07.02.2024

Level of Access: Open to Public

Classification Number: 2.11 ASL

Approving Authority: Academic Council

Registration Number: 18

Owner: Office of Global Relations

Revision Date: 07.02.2027

Applicability: Nazarbayev University

Retired Documents:

Title: Rules on academic mobility

Date: 06.12.2017

Registration Number: 13

Approving Authority: Academic Council

DIRECTUM-27926-4165333

Section 1. Purpose and Application

1.1. These Policy and Procedures on Student Mobility of the autonomous organization of education “Nazarbayev University” (hereinafter referred to as the Policy and Procedures) establishes general principles and procedures for Student Mobility at the autonomous organization of education “Nazarbayev University”.

1.2. These Policy and Procedures apply to all students participating in mobility programs, both incoming and outgoing. The Policy and Procedures are intended for the use by students, academic and administrative staff involved in the implementation of Student Mobility.

Section 2. Terms / Definitions

2.1. These Policy and Procedures use the following terms and definitions:

1) **Academic Exchange** is in-person or online academic study and/or research experience (credit-bearing) that a student is undertaking at the Host Institution for a period of time (semester or academic year), under the condition of the possibility of transfer of credits, waiver of tuition and corresponding expenses in case a Host institution is a Partner institution;

2) **Academic Mobility** is in-person or online academic experience that a student is undertaking at the Host Institution for a period of time (up to one academic year), which was formally approved and supported by his/her Home Institution (with written confirmation) on a free or fee-paying basis with the possibilities of credit transfer. Academic Mobility can be presented in the following forms: Academic Exchange, Study Abroad Program, Overseas Component and Customized Program;

3) **Cultural Program** is in-person or online short-term cultural exploration visit abroad. Students visit the Host Institution on a reciprocal or non-reciprocal basis. Subject to agreement, Cultural programs developed jointly with Partner institutions can involve mutual waiver of corresponding expenses;

4) **Customized Program** is a non-degree courses or courses over any semester or up to one year on a fee basis with the possibility for subsequent transfer of credits to their Home Institution taken by students and other individuals. It is not obligatory to be a degree-seeking student to participate in the program, however, applicants should meet general admission criteria and meet other eligibility criteria as indicated in items 3.5.1. and 3.6.1. of the Policy and Procedures or as stated in the inter-institutional agreement;

5) **Equivalent grade** is NU equivalent of the grade received by an Outgoing student at the Host Institution, which is calculated by the School;

6) **Exchange Student** is a student attending one of the Student Mobility programs for a certain period of time (up to one academic year), while pursuing a full academic degree at a Home Institution under the condition of transfer of credits with a waiver of tuition and corresponding expenses;

7) **Home Institution** is higher education institution where a student is pursuing a full academic degree;

8) **Host Institution** is higher education institution that receives an exchange student to pursue study for a certain period of time (up to one academic year), while pursuing a full academic degree at a Home Institution;

9) **Incoming Student** is a student attending NU Student Mobility for a certain period of time (up to one academic year), while pursuing a full academic degree at Home Institution;

10) **Incoming Visiting Student** – is an independent students and individuals attending NU under non-degree fee-based short-term study with the possibility of transfer of credits;

11) **Overseas component** is a built-in credit-bearing component within certain NU programs that requires studying abroad;

12) **NU – Student agreement** is an individual agreement between NU and incoming exchange student pursuing study at NU;

14) **NU School** is an academic structural unit of NU with the main functions of teaching, education, and research;

15) **Outgoing Student** is NU student attending Student Mobility at the Host Institution for a certain period of time (up to one academic year);

16) **Partner Institution** is an institution with which NU holds an inter-institutional agreement on the organization of the Mobility programs;

17) **Policy and Procedures** are the Policy and Procedures on Student Mobility of the autonomous organization of education "Nazarbayev University";

18) **Research Mobility** is an opportunity for students (credit-bearing/non-credit-bearing) for academic, research, or professional exchange of experience by attending classes and/or conducting joint research and/or implementing work assigned by the supervisor;

19) **School Selection Committee** is a committee established at each NU School responsible for selecting and approving students for Student Mobility (e.g., Student Selection Committee, School Travel Committee, etc.);

20) **Student Mobility** is an overall movement of students and researchers to the Host Institution to pursue educational opportunities or to conduct research;

21) **Study Abroad program** is credit-bearing study program at the Host Institution for a duration of up to one year on a non-reciprocal basis, with the possibility of transfer of credits;

22) **Summer School** is a courses of lectures held during school and university summer vacations, taken as part of an academic course or as an independent course of study for professional or personal purposes;

2.2. These Policy and Procedures use the following abbreviations:

1) **BO** – Bursar's Office;

2) **CGPA** – Cumulative Grade Point Average is an average of all the grades students received in all courses throughout their studying at Home Institution;

3) **DSS** – Department of Student Services;

4) **HWD** – Health and Well-being Department;

5) **IIA** – Inter-institutional agreement is an agreement between two higher education institutions that sets the framework conditions for the student mobility;

6) **MoU** – Memorandum of Understanding;

7) **NU** – Autonomous organization of education "Nazarbayev University";

8) **DI** – Department on Internationalization;

9) **OoP** – Office of the Provost;
10) **OoPGS** – Office of the Provost–Graduate Studies
11) **OR** – Office of the Registrar;

Section 3. Main Provisions

3.1. General Regulations

3.1.1. NU is committed to equality of opportunities and merit-based selection of students. Mobility programs are available to all students, regardless of funding source or citizenship. Participation in various types of Student Mobility is subject to meeting eligibility criteria stated in items 3.5.1. and 3.6.1. of these Policy and Procedures and conditions of particular types of Student Mobility.

3.1.2. Student Mobility is organized in accordance with inter-institutional or/and inter-governmental agreements and other relevant documents (fee-based contract with Partner Institution or fee-based agreement with individual applicant).

3.1.3. NU may consider full or partial funding of Student Mobility on a case–by–case basis depending on the availability of funds at NU Schools.

3.1.4. Issues not regulated by these Policy and Procedures shall be reviewed in accordance with the decision of the Academic Council and/or internal documents of NU.

3.1.5. NU recognizes the value of Student Mobility to the overall academic, professional, cultural, and personal development of students. Student Mobility experiences offer NU students various opportunities, including expanding their academic learning, developing cultural and global competencies that contribute to their acquisition of NU graduate attributes, enriching their professional learning and skills, enhancing personal development encompassing leadership abilities, social awareness, and global citizenship, and ultimately improving their employment prospects.

3.1.6. NU offers a range of Student Mobility experiences, listed in item 3.1.9. of these Policy and Procedures, offered by NU Schools, Partner Institutions, or independent providers. Students may also find opportunities for mobility outside of those provided by NU. In such cases, NU Schools has the right whether or not to approve or recognize those opportunities based on the principles and rules in these Policy and Procedures.

3.1.7. Providing students with opportunities for academically relevant mobility experiences as part of their study is an additional incentive opportunity provided by NU.

3.1.8. In cases where credits earned at a Host Institution are transferred and counted toward degree completion at NU, this must be done in accordance with these Policy and Procedures.

3.1.9. The following types of Student Mobility are recognized at NU (Table 1):

1) Academic Exchange – credit-bearing study program at a Partner Institution as an Exchange Student for the duration of one or two semesters (up to on academic year) with subsequent transfer of credits on the basis of reciprocal waivers of tuition, application and registration fees. Other possible corresponding expenses

are subject to inter-institutional agreement. Exchange Students should be nominated by Home Institutions;

2) Study Abroad Program – credit-bearing mobility program at the Host Institution for a duration of up to one year on a non-reciprocal basis, with the possibility of transfer of earned credits. The transfer of credits is subject to the NU Schools' decision;

3) Overseas Component – study abroad components that are built into the specific Master or PhD programs of the NU Schools;

4) Customized Programs – short-term study program for visiting students with non-degree credit-bearing courses or courses over any semester or up to one year on a fee basis with the possibility for subsequent transfer of credits to their Home Institution taken by students and other individuals. It is not obligatory to be a degree-seeking student to participate in the program, however, applicants should meet program admission criteria and meet other eligibility criteria as indicated in items 3.5.1. and 3.6.1. of these Policy and Procedures;

5) Research Mobility – an opportunity for students (credit-bearing/non-credit-bearing) for academic, research, or professional exchange of experience by attending classes and/or conducting joint research and/or implementing work assigned by the supervisor;

6) Cultural Mobility (non-/credit bearing) – short-term cultural exploration visit abroad. Students visit the Host Institution on a reciprocal or non-reciprocal basis. Subject to agreement Cultural programs developed jointly with Partner institutions can involve mutual waiver of corresponding expenses.

Table 1. Types of Student Mobility at NU

<table>
<tr><th>Types of Student Mobility</th><th>Student Status</th><th>Basis for Mobility</th></tr>
<tr><td>1. Academic Mobility</td><td></td><td></td></tr>
<tr><td>Academic Exchange</td><td>Incoming/Outgoing Exchange Student</td><td>IIA</td></tr>
<tr><td>Study Abroad</td><td>Outgoing Student</td><td>IIA and/or Scholarship Program and/or Confirmation Letter of Acceptance</td></tr>
<tr><td>Customized program</td><td>Incoming Visiting Student</td><td rowspan="2">IIA and/or NU-Student Agreement and/or Confirmation Letter of Acceptance</td></tr>
<tr><td>2. Research Mobility</td><td>Incoming/Outgoing Research Student</td></tr>
<tr><td>3. Cultural Mobility</td><td>Incoming/Outgoing Student</td><td>IIA and/or Official invitation</td></tr>
</table>

3.1.10. NU recognizes that even if the contents of Cultural mobility programs may partially provide study experience to participating students, these programs are considered non-credit bearing. In cases when credits are granted to NU students

attending Cultural mobility programs overseas, the transfer of earned credits might be considered by NU Schools on a case-by-case basis.

3.1.11. DI and relevant NU units will provide support to participants of Mobility programs through clear and comprehensive information, transparent processes, and administrative assistance throughout the duration of programs.

3.2. Responsibilities of the NU Units

3.2.1. The DI is responsible for the policy and guideline setting, control over the execution of contracts, control over the timely renewal of contracts and overall analysis. Besides, DI is mainly responsible for processes and procedures related to international mobility programs: communication with partners, coordination of mobility process, risk management and feedback analysis.

3.2.2. Experience Sharing Coordinator is mainly responsible for processes and procedures related to mobility programs with Kazakhstan institutions: communication with partners, coordination of mobility process, risk management and feedback analysis.

3.2.3. OoPGS is mainly responsible for processes and procedures related to Research Mobility programs with Kazakhstan institutions: communication with partners, coordination of mobility process for incoming masters and doctoral students and post-doctoral scholars.

3.2.4. NU Schools are responsible for the following processes and procedures: policy implementation; communication with partners; student application and selection; student trip preparation; risk management; documentation support; return of the student.

3.3. Legal Basis for Student Mobility

3.3.1. Legal Basis for Academic Exchange:

1) Inter-institutional agreement (for Academic Exchange) developed in consultation between the DI and/or the relevant NU School with the Partner Institution and signed between NU and/or NU School and the Partner Institution;

2) For Outgoing Student (Academic Exchange):

Minutes of the School Selection Committee, if the selection of the Exchange Student is required to be conducted by NU;

Memo from NU Schools to the Office of Registrar with approval from DI, DSS, HWD and BO;

Statement for exemption from responsibility and limits of acceptable risk signed by Exchange student (Appendix 2);

Student Trip Decision prepared by respective NU School;

3) For Incoming Students Exchange (Academic Exchange):

Memo from NU Schools to the Office of Registrar with endorsement from DI and DSS;

NU Schools may consider additional documents to accept incoming Exchange Student.

3.3.2. Legal basis for Study Abroad Program:

For Outgoing Students participating in Study Abroad Programs:

Confirmation letter of acceptance from Host Institution in case it is not a Partner Institution;

Decision of the Dean of the respective NU School on approval of study abroad program;

Memo from NU Schools to the Office of Registrar with approval from DI, DSS, HWD and BO;

Statement for exemption from responsibility and limits of acceptable risk signed by a student (Appendix 2);

Student Trip Decision prepared by respective NU School.

3.3.3. Legal basis for Overseas Component:

For Outgoing Students participating in Overseas Component:

Contracts signed between Strategic partners and NU should be considered as a basis for Overseas Component;

Statement for exemption from responsibility and limits of acceptable risk signed by a student (Appendix 2);

Student Trip Decision prepared by respective NU School.

3.3.4. Legal basis for Customized program at NU:

1) For Incoming Students within Customized programs:

Inter-Institutional agreement or contract between NU and potential Partner Institution or individual Agreement between NU School and Incoming student;

Decision of the Dean on acceptance of incoming students;

Memo from NU Schools to the Office of Registrar with approval from DI and DSS.

3.3.5. Legal basis for Cultural mobility programs:

1) Memorandum of Understanding or Inter-institutional agreement, developed in consultation between DI, relevant NU School, and the Partner Institution and signed between NU/NU School and the Partner Institution;

2) For Outgoing Students participating in Cultural mobility:

Minutes of the School Selection Committee, if the selection of the Exchange Student is required to be conducted by NU;

Memo from NU Schools to the Office of Registrar with approval from DI, DSS, HWD and BO;

Statement for exemption from responsibility and limits of acceptable risk signed by Exchange student (Appendix 2);

Student Trip Decision prepared by respective NU School;

3) For Incoming Students participating in Cultural mobility:

Decision of the Dean on acceptance of incoming students;

Memo from NU Schools to the Office of Registrar with approval from DI and DSS.

4) For Cultural mobility programs offered by NU the Policy for Non-Credit Bearing Courses should apply.

3.3.6. Legal Basis for Research Mobility:

1) Inter-Institutional agreement between NU and potential Partner Institution or an agreement with the incoming student, developed in consultation between the DI and/or the relevant NU Schools;

2) For Outgoing Students participating in Research Mobility:

Memo from NU Schools to the Office of Registrar with approval from DI, DSS, HWD and BO;

Statement for exemption from responsibility and limits of acceptable risk signed by Exchange student (Appendix 2);

Student Trip Decision prepared by respective NU School.

3) For Incoming Students participating in Research Mobility:

Agreement between NU Schools and Incoming Research Student or official letter from Home Institution with request to accept student for research internship;

Memo from NU Schools to the Office of Registrar with approval from DI, DSS, HWD and BO.

3.4. Establishment and Implementation of Student Mobility

3.4.1. If the participation of NU students in Student Mobility at the Host Institution is funded or co-funded by NU, the establishment of an inter-institutional agreement on the Mobility program between NU or NU Schools and the Host University is required, excluding Cultural Mobility which can be organized within MoU.e

3.4.2. Inter-institutional agreements with the Partner Institution should include information on housing arrangements, payment of fees, support offered to students, risk management procedures, supervision and student management, academic content, and the process for establishing and maintaining the academic credit of the programs. Inter-institutional agreements shall be signed by the authorized person.

3.4.3. Partner Institutions for Academic Exchange or Study abroad program shall be considered and approved by the Academic Council if there is an absence of signed MoU with NU. Partner Institutions shall meet one of the criteria listed below. DI is responsible for verifying that the Partner Institution meets one of the following criteria:

1) For Kazakhstani Institutions:

Kazakhstan accreditation agencies included into the European Quality Assurance Register for Higher Education;

Institutions with English as the main language of instruction (preferred);

Members of alliances and associations NU is part of;

2) International Institutions that meet one of the following criteria:

To be ranked in the top 500 list of Times Higher Education World University Ranking, or Academic Ranking of World Universities, or QS World University Ranking agencies (ranking for the last 3 years should be considered);

To be ranked in the top 300 in a subject area by the abovementioned ranking agencies. In this case, only the NU School from the matching area can send/host students (ranking for the last 3 years should be considered);

The exchange agreement is supported by the Erasmus+ program or other programs funded by the governments;

Participants and members of the Ivy League (the US), the Russel Group (the UK), and the C9 League (China);

Highly specialized universities;

Leading universities located in Eurasia;

Leading universities ranked by the national ranking agencies;

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Promising newly established universities.

3.4.4. If the Inter-Institutional agreement was initiated by the DI, the DI reserves the right to distribute the exchange opportunities among NU Schools.

3.4.5. If the Inter-Institutional agreement was initiated by the specific NU School, the School reserves the right to utilize the exchange opportunities within its own vision.

3.5. Mobility process for outgoing students

3.5.1. Eligibility and participation:

1) Subject to specific requirements of each program, all students may apply to participate in Mobility programs;

2) An Outgoing Student studying on Academic Exchange (for the period of 1-2 semesters) should be registered by OR to a placeholder course. Financial obligations on tuition fees and stipend provisions are regulated by the internal documents of NU;

3) In cases when selection for Student mobility is competitive, student applications are reviewed by the School Selection Committee;

4) To be eligible to participate in an outgoing Academic Mobility, a student must:

be currently enrolled at NU as a degree-seeking student, ensuring his/her studying at NU to be completed within 4 (four) years;

must have completed at least one academic year at NU (for undergraduate students) and at least one semester at NU (for graduate students);

an applicant must be in good standing during the whole period of studying at NU (i.e. not on probation or with conditional status, should not have any academic or/and disciplinary sanctions imposed);

have a CGPA of 3.0 and above (does not apply to programs with no GPA);

have no incomplete grades in any courses;

be 18 years old on the day of application to the Mobility program;

5) Evaluation of applications is based on:

academic merit;

academic and research reference, statement of purpose, and interview;

where relevant, a priority shall be given to students without academic mobility experience (if previous and current programs are funded by NU);

other relevant criteria, such as language skills, and social and community commitment, where applicable;

Eligibility and requirements for each kind of program will be announced by means of emails and/or posted on the web page of respective NU Schools.

3.5.2. Application process:

Applicants for outgoing Student mobility must submit to the appropriate School Selection Committee the following application materials:

a copy of passport;

a copy of the transcript;

a personal statement indicating the motivation and expected benefits of participating in Academic mobility;

Each School/program may have additional requirements. It is the responsibility of the student to understand the specific requirements of their School, indicated in the School handbook and/or the announcement about the program.

3.5.3. Selection and Departure for Mobility:

1) Each School may establish its own additional requirements that may be more detailed and shall complement and comply with these Rules;

2) A representative of the DI, DSS, HWD can participate in the School Selection Committee as an observer;

3) The number of nominated students financed by NU depends on funds available in the School budget;

4) The School Selection Committee should have the minutes of the meeting, which include a list of students selected for Student mobility and a ranking of other eligible students on the waiting list according to the requirements listed in the item 3.5.4. of these Policy and Procedures. Students from the waiting list may substitute selected students if the participation of selected students is not possible for any reason.

3.5.4. Before the student leaves for mobility program, the administrative staff of the respective NU School should:

1) prepare Memo to the OR;

2) submit a copy of the international health insurance of the Outgoing Student, which covers all days of Academic mobility to the HWD;

3) prepare the Statement for exemption from responsibility and limits of acceptable risk (Appendix 2) signed by the student;

4) prepare Student Trip Decision.

3.5.5. Selection and Departure for Academic Exchange:

1) DI informs Schools on the number of exchange places at Partner Institutions available for NU students each academic semester, in accordance with the respective inter-institutional agreements;

2) Outgoing Exchange Students should be nominated by School Selection Committees;

3) Any applicants beyond the agreed number of the student exchange program may be eligible to attend academic exchange program at the Host Institution on a fee-paying basis as a study abroad student if agreed by the parties;

4) Where the number of eligible applicants for exchange at a Partner Institution exceeds the number of places available, the School Selection Committee should rank applications according to the requirements listed in the item 6.1. of these Policy and Procedures.

5) Self-financed (self-initiated) academic exchange program to the Host Institution shall be considered as a Study Abroad arrangement.

3.5.6. Selection and Departure for Study Abroad programs and Overseas Component:

1) NU Schools recommend or approve students for the Study Abroad program and Overseas Component.

3.5.7. Selection and Departure for Cultural Mobility:

1) The School Selection Committee recommends students for Cultural programs financed by NU. The number of nominated students financed by NU

depends on funds available at the School. Partner Institution may provide scholarship to the nominated NU student;

2) The School Selection Committee should have the minutes of the meeting, which include a list of students selected for Cultural mobility and a ranking of other eligible students on the waiting list according to the requirements listed in the item 3.5.1. of these Policy and Procedures. Students from the waiting list may substitute selected students if the participation of selected students is not possible for any reason;

3) Scholarship for Cultural program may be provided to nominated students by Partner institution.

3.5.8. Selection and Departure for Research Mobility:

NU Schools recommends students for Research programs. The number of recommended students financed by NU depends on funds available at NU Schools.

3.5.9. Academic Recognition and Return from credit-bearing mobility program

1) The academic recognition in the form of credits granted for Academic Mobility and Study Abroad programs including online programs is a matter of academic judgment at the discretion of the Dean or designee. The Dean or designee has the right to decide on the number of credits to be transferred for courses taken at the Host Institution, including online courses. Credit transfer must be approved by the Dean or designee upon the examination of the student's application. The decision shall be informed by the course learning outcomes, which provide a basis for assessing the scope and level of rigor for courses taken outside the home institution;

2) All courses taken during Academic exchange, including online exchange and online Study abroad programs, must be taken for a letter or a number grade for the purpose of credit transfer. Courses graded on a Pass/Fail system may be considered for possible transfer on a case-by-case basis. Course grades during Academic exchange and Study abroad programs are not calculated in the NU CGPA;

3) All courses will be transferred to the transcript in a form of credits. The name of the Host Institution should be indicated in the transcript;

4) Each School identifies in the School handbook and/or in the other internal documents a minimum grade to “Pass” courses;

5) Academic recognition is determined on an individual basis and the student is responsible for confirming credit arrangements with the School and Host Institution;

6) After completion of an Academic exchange program and Study abroad program, the Host Institution should send an official academic transcript to OR, DI or NU Schools directly. Transcript transferred from Host Institution directly to Exchange Student are not valid. OR should inform the School of the grades received by students at a Host Institution;

7) The Academic transcript must:

be issued on an official transcript blank or official e-transcript blank;

be original. Copies or notarized copies are not accepted;

contain course title, course abbreviation, or course code (if any);

include the number of credits with an indication of the credit system (can be on the back side) and grade;

contain the transcript sealed in the envelope with the Host institution’s official seal. In case the envelope has been opened, the transcript cannot be accepted;

8) The Dean or designee is responsible for calculating the NU equivalence of the grade received at the Host Institution. Transcript should be sent by School to OR, stating the number of credits to be transferred. Program with an External Credits Transfer Form should be attached and submitted to OR via email;

9) Upon receipt of the transcript, OR sends a list of students eligible for a stipend to the Bursar's Office;

10) Alternative types of grades is not calculated in CGPA, however, is used as a basis for the decision on granting a stipend in the semester following the Academic Mobility period;

11) NU undergraduate students may extend their time on Academic Mobility for up to one academic year with the permission of the NU Schools and the Host Institution, and subject to an approved study plan and appropriate financing;

12) Outgoing students upon return from Academic Mobility follow the established procedures for course registration for the semester at NU;

3.5.10. Other provisions:

13) NU students approved for Academic Mobility are advised to be registered at NU course until final acceptance from Host Institution for the cases when they are unable to proceed with their mobility program in the planned semester;

14) NU students who commence Academic Mobility and wish to withdraw are subject to the terms of the respective IIA. Relevant policies and procedures of the Host Institution will also apply;

15) Students who wish to defer or withdraw from Academic Mobility program should inform respective NU Schools and DI as early as possible;

16) Deferral of Academic Mobility programs should be considered and approved by NU Schools and accepted by Partner Institution;

17) NU Schools should inform OR on withdrawal from Academic Mobility so that OR could make the necessary adjustments in that student's records in the system;

18) Either DI or NU Schools can negotiate with another university to establish the partnership framework for the academic mobility program. Negotiations and preliminary agreements are made to set the foundation for the program;

19) The agreement should signed between potential Partner University and DI/NU Schools, solidifying the partnership and commitment to academic mobility;

20) Responsible NU School or the DI conveys essential information about deadlines, requirements, and the number of mobility opportunities available between NU and the partner institution. Approval from DI or NU Schools is sought to proceed with the program;

21) DI is responsible for managing the distribution of mobility opportunities among different schools and disciplines within the institution, balancing opportunities;

22) DI notifies NU Schools about the exchange opportunities available to students;

23) NU Schools notify their respective students about the exchange opportunities available and initiate the selection process;

24) After NU Schools select and nominate students for academic mobility, the nominations are then transferred to DI;

25) DI transfers the nominated students' details to the partner institution and awaits confirmation of acceptance from them;

26) NU Schools receive final confirmation of student acceptance from the partner institution, ensuring that the selected students can participate in the exchange program;

27) Nominated students can apply for funding from NU, depending on the availability of financial support for the exchange program;

28) Nominated students prepare the necessary documents for their trip, including obtaining a visa, health insurance, arranging travel tickets, and securing housing accommodations;

29) DI and NU Schools collaborate on risk management measures, including providing emergency contact information to ensure the safety and well-being of students during their academic mobility;

30) After completing the academic mobility, DI, NU Schools, and students are responsible for transferring credits earned during the exchange, obtaining the transcript from the partner institution, and making a decision on the completion of academic mobility;

31) DI collects feedback from students who participated in the academic mobility program through surveys, allowing for continuous improvement and refinement of the program;

32) Mobility process table for outgoing student presented in Appendix 3.

3.6. Mobility process for incoming students

3.6.1. Eligibility and participation

1) Incoming Student:

should meet English language proficiency requirements set out in the Admission rules of each program. Language proficiency requirement can be waived in the following cases: one of the earlier academic degrees was earned in a country with English as the language of official communication, academic instruction, and daily life; an undergraduate degree is/was earned in a program that is/was officially taught in English; have passed equivalent of 60 ECTS (European Credits) in English-taught courses. In case this information is not clear from the transcript, the Home institution shall issue an English proficiency letter (confirmation); should have a competitive CGPA in his/her current degree;

agree to be responsible for tuition fee costs (excluding Exchange Students), health insurance and other costs, if requested. In case of sponsorship by an external organization, the incoming student should inform DI and NU Schools and provide written confirmation of thereof;

if applying as an Exchange Student, the student must be nominated by his/her Home Institution;

must agree to abide by NU rules and regulations and the internal security regime;

eligibility for each kind of program is set out in the announcement sent by email by the School and DI or posted on the web page of the Hosting institution;

2) For Research internships, NU Schools may establish their own requirements for accepting incoming students, other than those determined above in sub-clauses 1)-

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6), which should be approved by the Dean. School Learning and Teaching Committee may recommend additional requirements that should be approved by the Dean of the respective School. For Incoming students, the Dean should approve the availability of all resources needed for effective implementation;

3) This should be reflected in an authorization form of the internship proposal, which is sent to the NU Academic Quality Committee for notification only;

4) Research internship is provided on a fee-paying or non-fee-paying basis, which is resolved at the discretion of the Dean of the School. The cost for fee paying basis is determined within an agreement between NU and the Partner institution / Incoming Student or in an invoice issued to the Partner institution / Incoming Student, including terms of reference.

3.6.2. Application Process

1) Applicants to Academic, Research, and Cultural Mobility programs and courses submit the following documents to NU School:

CV;

copy of the transcript;

copy of passport;

a personal statement indicating the motivation and expected benefits of participating in Academic mobility;

Submitted documents of the nominated students should be shared with DI.

2) The applicant of Customized Program must proceed with required procedures established by respective NU Schools. When the duration of Customized Program is less than the NU academic semester or taken during Summer applicants must submit the application to the respective NU School:

Letter of request for acceptance;

CV;

copy of transcript;

copy of passport;

a brief statement of motivations and expected benefits from participating in a Short-term study;

signed agreement on Customized Program;

3) For incoming applicants to Research Mobility School assigns a faculty member as a supervisor who conducts safety and health induction and ensures the compliance of the incoming student with the health and safety rules established at NU. Research Mobility requires submission of the Research Internship Proposal form (Appendix 1). Research Internship Proposal form should include key information on the process, ensuring that it is aligned with current Policy and Procedures. The proposal must be sent to the School Learning and Teaching Committee for review; The School Learning and Teaching Committee may either recommend the proposed document for approval or reject it and require that it to be revised and resubmitted. The School Learning and Teaching Committee's decision should be reflected in their minutes;

4) NU School may request other documents in addition to those listed in the items 3.5.1. of these Policy and Procedures and have additional requirements. It is the responsibility of the student to understand the specific policies of the School he/she is applying to;

5) NU Schools review the application for Customized Program and transfers applications of eligible candidates to the respective School Admission Committee for consideration and approval;

6) NU Schools' Selection Committee evaluates the application of Incoming Students, reviews his/her academic background, and states its decision in the minutes;

7) There are no fixed deadlines for applications for Academic Mobility. However, if otherwise is not stated by the program or respective agreements it is recommended to apply for the Fall semester – in April, for the Spring semester – in October, and for the Summer semester – in March;

8) Application deadlines can be changed at the discretion of NU School in order to process late applications provided there is enough time to register the incoming student and to complete all necessary arrangements;

9) If available exchange slots for Incoming Students at NU are insufficient to meet the demand, Partner Institutions will be asked to rank eligible students. Any student applications beyond the agreed number of Exchange Students with Partner Institutions might be eligible for consideration to attend NU as part of the Customized Program.

3.6.3. Enrolment and Arrival at NU:

1) NU Schools should:

prepare decision of the Dean or Designee on acceptance of Incoming Students for Academic mobility;

submit the memo to OR with approval from DI together with copy of decision on acceptance. Original copy should be registered and stored by NU Schools;

ensure providing a student account for incoming students in the Registrar database as long as their program of studies require a course registration. The creation of a student account should be arranged before students arrive at NU;

arrange enrollment of Incoming Students for courses;

inform DSS with regards to include an Incoming student in the list for dormitory allocation and assist with placement if necessary;

work with Bursar's office for invoice and payment processing, if a student is accepted on a fee-paying basis;

assist students with other organizational issues during their study at NU;

prepare a visa invitation letter from the Dean of the respective NU School and submit all documents to DI no later than one month prior to the Incoming Student's arrival if relevant;

2) Incoming Student may amend his/her study plan subject to the approval of the hosting NU School. Incoming student should consider the NU Academic calendar. It is the responsibility of an Incoming Student to ensure that any amendments are approved by his/her Home Institution;

3) Orientation and support for Incoming Students will be coordinated by respective NU School and other relevant units;

4) DI will support Incoming Students with the visa application process, registration with authorities, and other related issues;

5) Non-credit bearing Research Mobility does not require formal enrollment and may not be necessarily applicable in case of arrival at NU for non-credit bearing Research internship. If needed, Incoming Students on Research Mobility should be

provided with the access to the campus and relevant facilities with the approval from hosting NU Schools.

3.6.4. Academic Recognition:

1) The academic recognition (in the form of credits) granted for a NU Academic Mobility program is a matter of academic judgment at the discretion of the Home Institution and School. Credit transfer should be agreed upon prior to a student's participation in the program;

2) School and the OR arrange delivery of academic transcripts and/or a Certificate of Completion to their Home institutions;

3) Upon completion of the Research Internship, the participants may receive a certificate of attendance if no assessment was conducted, or a certificate of completion if an assessment on the designated learning outcomes was formally undertaken and approved by the participant. The official NU logo and/or reference to NU may be used on condition of approval by the respective NU School Learning and Teaching Committee and the Dean.

3.6.5. Other provisions:

1) Incoming Students on Mobility programs except for applicants to Cultural mobility and Short-term study must study full-time at their Home institutions. The recommended study load should comply with the minimum and maximum load prescribed by NU and the Home Institution;

2) Visiting students on Short-term fee-paying study may choose to enroll in any number of available courses for any period of time subject to agreement with the Host School;

3) Incoming Undergraduate Exchange Students may extend their time at NU up to any period with the permission of their Home Institution, School, and DI, in accordance with the formal inter-institutional agreement and subject to an approved study plan. Graduate Exchange Students are not permitted to extend their exchange period;

4) Students approved for Academic Mobility must re-apply if they are unable to proceed with their program in the planned semester. Deferral of Academic Mobility may not be possible;

5) Students who wish to defer or withdraw should inform DI and their respective Schools as early as possible. The School should then inform OR so that OR could make the necessary adjustments in that student's records in the system;

6) Tuition fee refund procedures should be described in the respective agreement. The Bursar's Office is responsible for any payment issues related to participants in fee-based mobility programs including short-term studies;

7) Processing fees charged for administrative, visa, and insurance purposes will not be reimbursed in case of withdrawal, deferral, or cancellation of the program (if applicable);

8) DI or NU Schools negotiate with another university to establish the partnership framework for the academic mobility program. Negotiations and preliminary agreements are made to set the foundation for the program;

9) The agreement is signed between the partner university or an individual and DI/NU School, solidifying the partnership and commitment to academic mobility;

10) DI communicates and transfers all important details to the partner institution. This includes sharing information about the number of students to be accepted, deadlines, eligibility criteria, available courses, and necessary documents for the application package (i.e., English proficiency, CGPA, personal statement, and CV);

11) DI receives the list of students, nominated to the student exchange program with NU. Then, DI transfers the list of students to NU Schools;

12) NU Schools review and approve the list of nominated students for the program;

13) The Schools confirm to DI the list of students to be accepted for the exchange program. The process involves sharing the protocols of the School Selection Committees with DI;

14) DI provides the final confirmation of student acceptance to the partner institution, completing the process of student selection;

15) NU Schools and DI collaborate to prepare admitted students for their academic mobility. This includes providing necessary information about the admission package, visa requirements, academic calendar, health insurance, housing, arrival dates, campus map;

16) The arrival of students at NU. It includes the following procedures: requesting access to campus access, meeting with the incoming student, conducting orientation sessions, registering an IIN, opening a local bank account, and assisting students with class registration;

17) After completing the academic mobility, DI, and NU Schools are responsible for transferring credits earned during the exchange, providing the transcripts to the partner institution, and making a decision on the completion of academic mobility;

18) DI collects feedback from students who participated in the academic mobility program through surveys, enabling improvements in future iterations of the program;

19) Mobility process table for incoming student presented in Appendix 4.

3.7. Roles and responsibilities of students

3.7.1. Students should follow the required application procedures for Student Mobility programs after checking the feasibility of undertaking a preferred program with the faculty and eligibility for the respective program, comply with the conditions of the respective program once accepted, and successfully complete the academic requirements of the program in order to receive credits.

3.7.2. Outgoing students shall provide the required information, including vaccinations, health conditions, or any required and important information that can affect the successful completion of the Student Mobility prior to their departure to the Partner Institution. Incoming Exchange, Research, and Visiting students shall provide the required information, including vaccination, health condition, or any important information (including mental health and/or additional requirements for the learning

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process) that can affect the successful completion of Student Mobility prior to their arrival at NU.

3.7.3. Outgoing students shall have health insurance that covers medical emergency conditions, inpatient and outpatient health services for the whole period of the Student Mobility, as well as medical evacuation and repatriation. Incoming Exchange, Research, and Visiting students shall have health insurance that covers medical emergency conditions, inpatient and outpatient health services for the whole period of Student Mobility, vaccination (if applicable), as well as medical evacuation and repatriation.

3.7.4. Students undertaking Student Mobility programs must abide by:

1) Policy, procedures, and requirements of the Host Institution and the laws and regulations of the country in which the program is held;

2) Policy, procedures, and requirements of the Home Institution and the laws and regulations of the Home country.

3.7.5. Where a student is found to be in breach of any law or regulation, or requirements of the program, withdraws or acts in a way that brings Home and/or Host Institution into disrepute, participation in the Mobility program may be terminated by Home and/or Host Institution. Students who have breached requirements may be removed from the program and requested to return to their Home Institution at their own expense.

3.7.6. Students whose participation in a Mobility program is terminated on the grounds of misconduct or failure to abide by program requirements and terms of the respective agreement, might be required to return any funding provided by Home Institution or another funding body, which funded/supported their participation in Student Mobility.

3.7.7. If Outgoing Students are unable to meet graduation requirements by the end of the last semester of their final year, due to participation in Student Mobility or any other reason, they may be considered for the additional semester (year) of study, on a per credit cost. In this case, relevant NU policies on the maximum duration of study shall apply to undergraduate students.

3.7.8. Incoming Students undertaking Student Mobility at NU are bound by all applicable NU rules, policies, and procedures. Where an allegation of misconduct has been upheld for an Incoming Student, DI will provide details to the student's Home Institution as appropriate.

3.7.9. Students enrolled at NU may submit a complaint or appeal regarding Student Mobility or implementation of these Policy and Procedures to the Vice Provost for Academic Affairs.

3.8. Procedure in the case of "force majeure" impacting mobility

3.8.1. Force majeure is a situation, when there has occurred any unexpected event that has been beyond control of Exchange Student or Host Institution, and has not been caused by deliberate action or neglecting during mobility period abroad.

3.8.2. In the case of 'force majeure' Exchange Student should immediately inform Home Institution on the emergency situation that happened. Any student or staff who has decided to terminate or to cancel mobility due to the event of 'force

majeure', should immediately contact their Home institution to report the termination/cancellation of their mobility by sending an email to DI.

3.8.3. Student should prepare and submit to DI a description of the event that happened to cancel or terminate the mobility program (in a free form);

3.8.4. If, for some justified reasons, mobility has been cancelled and exchange student has already incurred some of the costs (e.g. plane tickets were purchased, accommodation was booked, etc.), then exchange student may apply for recognition of the costs incurred which could not be recovered in another way.

Section 4. Waiver

4.1. Only the Academic Council is authorized to wave from one or another provision of these Policy and Procedures.

Section 5. Temporary Provision

5.1. Not applicable.

Section 6. Revision

6.1. These Policy and Procedures shall be reviewed every three years after their approval and revised if necessary.

Section 7. Related Documents

7.1. Not applicable.

Appendix 1
to the Policy and Procedures on Student Mobility of the autonomous organization of education "Nazarbayev University"

Internship Proposal Template

1. General information:		
Internship Title:	School:	
Instructor(s):	Contact information:	
External student(s):	Contact information:	
Sending university:	Contact information:	
Internship Duration:	Internship Dates (schedule):	
Type of enrollment: (tick)		
a. Open enrollment [1] ☐	b. Restricted Enrollment[2] ☐ Details:	c. Contract/Agreement[3] ☐ Details:
2. Internship		
Internship description: a brief description of the internship.		
Internship aims (IAs): 1. 2. 3.		
Internship learning outcomes[4] (ILOs): 1. 2. 3.		
Teaching and learning activities and methods:		
Structure and content of the internship:		
Quality assurance and enhancement: Mechanisms that will be used to monitor and improve satisfaction with the course.		
3. Authorization Form		

[1] Course is open to any and all registrants without regard to age or ability.
[2] Course is offered to a specific audience only.
[3] Course is offered to a company or group based on a contract for training.
[4] LOs should define the knowledge, skills and attributes that students should be able to demonstrate by the end of the course. It is advised that the LOs be designed in consultation with the industry/potential employers, representatives from professional bodies.

Review by the School Learning and Teaching Committee
Recommended for approval ☐
Minutes #_____of the School Learning and Teaching Committee meeting held on_____20_____
Chair of the Learning and Teaching Committee _____ (name, signature)
Dean of the School
Internship proposal approved ☐ Dean (name and signature) _____ Date _____
Signed and scanned copies of the internship proposal document and the minutes of the School Learning and Teaching Committee meeting should be sent to the Department of Strategic Planning and Experience Sharing for the record and to the Office of Global Relations for notification, upon completion of the internship by the external student(s). Original copies should be kept in Schools.

Appendix 2
to the Policy and Procedures on Student Mobility of the autonomous organization of education "Nazarbayev University"

STATEMENT FOR EXEMPTION FROM RESPONSIBILITY AND LIMITS OF ACCEPTABLE RISK

Read the statement carefully and sign it. Your signature on this statement confirms that you have received and read this statement and the Policy and Procedures on Student Mobility of the autonomous organization of education "Nazarbayev University". If you don't understand any statement, discuss it with the university officials in charge of organizing this _____ (program) at _____ (Host Institution*), _____ (Host Country). If you have not reached the age of 18, this document must be signed by your parent or legal guardian.*

DISCLAIMER

I understand and agree that the organizers of _____ (program) (hereinafter referred to as the Program) at _____ (Host Institution), _____ (Host Country) represented by the autonomous organization of education Nazarbayev University (hereinafter referred to as the University), conducted for students of the University from _____ to _____, are not liable to me personally and my family for any damage, loss of personal property, death, injury, damage or injury that occurred through my fault or under circumstances resulting from my negligence.

Having received permission to participate in the Program, I take responsibility for the possible risks, foreseen and unforeseen, to which I am exposed while participating in the Program.

I undertake to comply with the laws of the Republic of Kazakhstan and _____ (Host Country), including _____ (e.g. host city, town, etc.), the rules and regulations of Nazarbayev University and the host country, and follow the instructions of the organizers.

I also undertake not to prosecute the Program and exempted parties on my own behalf, or on behalf of my family, and not to file complaints about my enrollment and participation in the Program. I relieve the University of any responsibility, claims based on the results of my participation in the Program.

I acknowledge that I have received this document and have read all the conditions before signing it. I declare that I have the legal right to sign this disclaimer. I understand that the conditions given in this document are contractual and not just listed for taking note. I acknowledge that I have signed this document of my own free will.

_____

Student Name (in block letters)

_____ _____

Student Signature Date (Day / Month / Year)

_____ _____

Signature of parent / guardian (if necessary) Date (Day / Month / Year)

Appendix 3
to the Policy and Procedures on Student Mobility of the autonomous organization of education "Nazarbayev University"

Mobility Process for Outgoing Students

Stage	Activity	Unit
Establishment	Negotiation and preliminary agreements	DI or NU Schools
Implementation	Signing Agreement	DI or NU Schools
	Communication with Partner: deadlines number of mobility	DI or NU Schools' approval
	Distribution of slots for mobility: by Schools by discipline	DI Key factor: balance of opportunities
	Announcement to the NU Schools	DI
Student Application & Selection	Announcement of the exchange opportunities to Students	NU Schools
	Transfer nominations from NU Schools to DI	NU Schools
	Transfer nominations from DI to Partner and receive confirmation of acceptance from Partner	DI
	Final confirmation of acceptance to NU students	NU Schools
Student Trip Preparation	Memo to OR with approval from DI Student Trip Order	NU Schools Nominated Student
	Application for NU funding (optional, depends on the availability of finance)	Nominated Student
	Trip documents preparation: Visa Ticket Housing	Nominated Student DI and NU Schools
Risk Management	Emergency Contact	DI, Schools
Return	Credit Transfer Transcript from Partner to NU	DI, NU Schools Student
	Feedback Survey from Students	DI

Appendix 4
to the Policy and Procedures on Student Mobility of the autonomous organization of education "Nazarbayev University"

Mobility Process for Incoming Students

Stage	Activity	Unit
Establishment	Negotiation and preliminary agreements	DI or NU School
Implementation	Signing Agreement Inter-Institutional Agreement - Incoming Exchange Student; Inter-Institutional Agreement or Contract – for Visiting students or Customized Programs Inter-Institutional Agreement or Letter of request for acceptance – for Research Students	DI or NU School
	Communication with Partner number of students to be accepted deadlines eligibility criteria list of courses available application package (English, CGPA, personal statement, CV)	DI NU Schools' approval
Student Application & Selection	Transfer the list of nominated students for NU to the Schools	DI
	Selection and Approval of nominated Incoming students	NU Schools
	Confirmation from NU Schools to DI Memo of the School to OR be shared with DI	
	Final Confirmation of acceptance to NU from DI to Partner	DI
Student Trip Preparation	Visa Academic Calendar Health insurance Housing Dates of arrival Map of Campus Emergency contact form	NU Schools DI
Arrival	Request for access Next day upon arrival session NU Orientation for Fall Incoming Session or Buddy orientation for Spring Incoming IIN	NU Schools DI

	Temporary Residence Permit (TRP) for CIS countries Class registration	
Return	Credit Transfer Transcript from NU to Partner	DI NU Schools OR
	Feedback Survey from Students	DI